

Time and Eternity

by Terry Presgrove

We are finite beings, bound by the rhythm and sequence of time. From the moment we are born, we live within its steady march—sleeping, waking, eating, learning, working, aging, and, in the end, dying. Time frames every part of our earthly existence.

The following poem captures the quiet power time holds over our lives:

Time

Time is relative.
Time is all-encompassing.
Time wakes us up,
and tucks us in at night.
Time tells us when we're hungry,
and marches us to work.
Time starts our journey,
and cries foul—
when we overstay our welcome.
Time marks the first whimper,
and bemoans the last groan.
Time will never end
till the last trumpet's roar,
Then, and only then,
will time be no more.

With fading memories, we look back on our past; we experience the present in fleeting moments; and we face the future as an uncertain mystery. But God is not like us.

Scripture presents God as the eternal Creator who stands above His creation. Moses declared:

“Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever you had formed the earth and the world, from everlasting to everlasting you are God.”

—Psalm 90:2

The apostle John begins his Gospel by placing Christ before creation itself:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”
—John 1:1

And Jesus declared:

“Before Abraham was, I am.”
—John 8:58

Scripture therefore gives us a foundational truth: God did not come into existence within the universe. He is the eternal God who created it. Genesis 1:1 begins with the words, “In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth.” The biblical story begins with creation, while God is already there.

But we must be careful about what Scripture does—and does not—tell us about the nature of eternity.

The Bible clearly teaches God's eternity, His omniscience, His transcendence over creation, and His sovereign knowledge of the future. The conclusion that God therefore experiences reality in a completely timeless “eternal present” is a theological inference rather than a statement Scripture makes in those exact words. It is an ancient and respected Christian understanding, developed by theologians such as Augustine and explored by writers such as Arthur C. Custance and C. S. Lewis. It is also a mystery.

That distinction is important throughout this discussion.

What follows is therefore not an attempt to establish a doctrine where Scripture gives us no explicit doctrine. Rather, it is an exploration of what may reasonably follow from the biblical portrait of God's eternity and omniscience.

The Proposition: Eternity Is More Than Endless Time

Albert Einstein once made an observation about the relationship between matter, space, and time:

“If we assume that all matter would disappear from the world...there would no longer be any space or time.”

Arthur Custance used this observation as a starting point for considering the relationship between time and eternity. His argument was that if time is inseparably connected with the physical universe, then eternity should not simply be understood as time continuing forever. Rather, eternity may represent an entirely different category of existence.

This is a profound idea.

Time has long fascinated me. It is the framework that governs every heartbeat of our earthly existence, yet when we try to contemplate eternity—a state unlike our ordinary experience of time—we quickly reach the limits of our understanding.

Our minds are conditioned by clocks and calendars. We think in terms of before and after, yesterday and tomorrow, beginning and ending. We cannot easily conceive of existence in which those categories do not operate in the same way.

Yet Scripture repeatedly places God beyond the limitations that govern us.

Peter writes:

“With the Lord one day is as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.”
—2 Peter 3:8

Peter is not giving us a mathematical formula for converting divine time into human time. He is emphasizing the vast difference between God's perspective and ours.

The psalmist says:

“For a thousand years in your sight are but as yesterday when it is past, or as a watch in the night.”
—Psalm 90:4

And Isaiah records God's declaration:

“I am God, and there is no other; I am God, and there is none like me, declaring the end from the beginning and from ancient times things not yet done.”
—Isaiah 46:9–10

The Bible therefore gives us the foundation for the discussion: God is eternal, God knows the end from the beginning, and God is not limited by our creaturely perspective of time.

What we must be cautious about is going beyond Scripture and pretending that we know precisely *how* God experiences eternity.

Eternity Is Not Simply “A Very Long Time”

One way of understanding eternity is to think of it as endless duration—a line that stretches forever into the future. That is certainly how we commonly use the word.

But there is another theological understanding: eternity is not merely an infinitely extended timeline. It is fundamentally different from the temporal existence we experience now.

Augustine famously described eternity as that which “stands and does not pass.” In this understanding, eternity does not consist of moments following one another as ours do.

This concept is difficult because every experience we have is sequential.

We were children. Then we became adults. Yesterday preceded today, and today will give way to tomorrow. We cannot step outside that sequence.

Perhaps the best way to illustrate the distinction is to imagine a panoramic photograph.

The Panoramic Photograph

Imagine a panoramic photograph—not capturing merely one moment, but somehow encompassing the whole course of history: from the dawn of creation to the culmination of history in the return of Christ and the establishment of the New Heavens and New Earth.

Now imagine zooming in on different points within this vast image.

What do we see?

Adam reaching for the fruit extended by Eve.

Napoleon, defeated, lying in his tent after Waterloo.

Roosevelt, solemn and resolute, speaking to the nation after Pearl Harbor.

JFK riding through Dallas beneath a bright November sky.

But beyond these familiar moments are countless scenes that history books never recorded—trillions of quiet episodes in the lives of ordinary people, scattered across thousands of years and countless places.

Every one of them is known to God.

But there is an important distinction here: God is not merely an observer who happens to possess a perfect view of the timeline. *He created the timeline.*

Time itself is part of His creation. “In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth” (Genesis 1:1). Before there was a created universe unfolding through time, God already was.

God therefore does not merely know the past, present, and future—He created the temporal order in which those distinctions exist for His creatures. He is not a being who entered time and learned to navigate it. He is the eternal Creator who brought the created order, including time as we experience it, into existence.

From our perspective, history unfolds one moment after another. We live within the sequence. Yesterday becomes today, and today becomes tomorrow.

But God is not a creature moving along the timeline with us. He stands as its Creator and Sustainer.

The photograph is only an analogy. God is not literally standing somewhere outside the universe looking at a photograph, nor does Scripture tell us that the entire future exists as a completed photograph in exactly this way. The illustration simply helps us imagine the vast difference between *our experience of history* and *God's complete knowledge and sovereign perspective over history*.

God knows the beginning, the middle, and the end.

He knows what we call the past. He knows what we call the present. He knows what we call the future.

And none of this knowledge is difficult for Him.

He declared through Isaiah:

“I am God, and there is no other; I am God, and there is none like me, declaring the end from the beginning and from ancient times things not yet done.”
—Isaiah 46:9–10

The God who declares the end from the beginning is not merely looking ahead along a road He did not create. *He created the road.*

God Outside Time—Yet His Creation Experiences Time

Here we need to make an important distinction.

If God is eternal and not limited by time in the way His creatures are, that does not mean that *time is unreal for His creatures*.

Scripture presents creation as unfolding through sequence.

God creates light, and then darkness. Evening comes, and morning follows. Plants appear, living creatures are created, humanity is formed, and history begins to unfold.

God enters into relationship with people within that history.

Abraham lives before Moses. Moses lives before David. David lives before Christ. Christ comes “in the fullness of time.” The apostles preach the gospel. The Church awaits the return of Christ.

Biblical history is therefore genuinely sequential.

God may transcend time without His creation ceasing to experience time.

This distinction is crucial.

A timeless God does not require a timeless creation.

Indeed, Scripture appears to describe a created order in which sequence, change, waiting, anticipation, fulfillment, and historical progression are real.

The incarnation itself demonstrates this. The eternal Son entered human history at a particular point in time.

Paul writes:

“But when the fullness of time had come, God sent forth his Son.”
—Galatians 4:4

The Son who existed “in the beginning” entered our temporal world.

Likewise, the resurrection occurred at a particular point in history, and the Second Coming remains a future event from our present earthly perspective.

Thus, we should distinguish between *God's relationship to time* and *the experience of time by created beings*.

God does not need to be bound by the temporal sequence in order for His creatures to be.

The Author and the Story

C. S. Lewis offered one of the most helpful illustrations of this distinction.

Imagine an author writing a novel.

The characters inside the story experience events sequentially. One thing happens, and then another. They have a past and a future within the story.

But the author is not a character moving through the story's timeline. The author can consider chapter one while simultaneously knowing what happens in chapter twenty. The characters cannot do that. Their experience is sequential; the author's knowledge encompasses the entire story.

Lewis illustrated this idea by imagining an author writing a scene in which a doorbell rings. The author writes that the doorbell rings, but then stops writing. He gets up from his desk and goes to answer his own doorbell. Perhaps an hour passes before he returns to his manuscript. Yet for the characters in the story, not a single moment has passed. When the author resumes writing, the doorbell is still ringing at the very moment he left the story.

The author experienced an hour outside the story's timeline, while the characters experienced no passage of time at all.

This is not a perfect analogy, because God is infinitely more than an author and we are not fictional characters. But it gives us a glimpse of how the Creator can relate to a temporal creation without being confined by its sequence of events.

We experience history from within it.

God is its Creator and Sustainer.

Paul writes:

“For from him and through him and to him are all things.”
—Romans 11:36

And concerning Christ:

“All things were created through him and for him.”
—Colossians 1:16

The Creator therefore possesses a perspective unavailable to His creatures.

The illustration also helps us understand why God's knowledge of the future does not require Him merely to “look ahead” along a timeline. He created the timeline itself. What is future to us is not hidden from Him.

As Lewis's illustration suggests, the Creator can relate to His creation from a perspective fundamentally different from that of the creatures living within it.

The Past and Future Seen by God

It is one thing to entrust an unknown future into the hands of an all-knowing God. It is another to contemplate the fact that our past—the parts of life we consider sealed, settled, and lost—remains completely known to Him.

For us, the past is gone.

We cannot retrieve yesterday. We cannot return to a conversation from twenty years ago or relive a moment that has disappeared.

Our memories are imperfect. Some fade. Some become distorted. Some events we remember vividly may not have occurred exactly as we remember them.

But nothing is lost to God.

The writer of Hebrews says:

“No creature is hidden from his sight, but all are naked and exposed to the eyes of him to whom we must give account.”

—Hebrews 4:13

God's knowledge does not suffer from the limitations of human memory.

Isaiah tells us that God declares “the end from the beginning.”

From our perspective, the future is unknown.

From God's perspective, nothing is unknown.

That does not mean that we understand how divine foreknowledge relates to human freedom. That mystery remains.

C. S. Lewis offered a helpful way of thinking about it: perhaps our difficulty comes from imagining God moving along the same timeline we do, merely possessing a better view of what lies ahead.

Lewis suggested instead that God may stand outside the temporal sequence itself. His conclusion was expressed cautiously: “Almost certainly God is not in Time.” He presented the idea as a Christian understanding, not as a doctrine required of every believer.

That qualification is important.

The timelessness of God is a profound theological concept, but Scripture does not require every Christian to settle every philosophical question about it.

Practical Implications for Believers

1. Trust in Divine Timing

Believers can find comfort in knowing that God's purposes are not threatened by our inability to see the future.

We see one piece of the puzzle at a time.

God sees the whole.

What appears to us to be delay may be preparation. What appears to be interruption may be part of His providence.

Paul reminds us:

“We know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose.”
—Romans 8:28

2. Prayer and God's Presence

If God is not limited by our temporal limitations, then we do not need to imagine Him overwhelmed by millions of prayers arriving simultaneously.

Jesus said:

“Your Father knows what you need before you ask him.”
—Matthew 6:8

C. S. Lewis illustrated this beautifully by imagining millions of people praying at the same moment. God does not need to process those prayers the way a human being would. Lewis concluded that God has “infinite attention to spare for each one of us.”

This is more than an interesting philosophical observation.

It is comforting.

When we pray, we are not competing with millions of other believers for God's attention.

3. Living With an Eternal Perspective

The believer is called to live with eternity in view.

Paul writes:

“We look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal.”
—2 Corinthians 4:18

Our present circumstances are real, but they are not ultimate.

Our suffering is real, but it is not permanent.

Our earthly lives are temporary, but God's purposes extend beyond them.

4. Reassurance of God's Omniscience

God sees what we cannot see.

He knows the past completely. He knows the present perfectly. He knows the future exhaustively.

Psalm 139 expresses this beautifully:

“Even before a word is on my tongue, behold, O LORD, you know it altogether.”
—Psalm 139:4

Nothing about us surprises God.

5. Freedom and Responsibility

The relationship between God's foreknowledge and human responsibility remains one of the great mysteries of theology.

Scripture teaches both truths.

God is sovereign.

Human beings are responsible for their choices.

Joseph could say to his brothers:

“You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good.”
—Genesis 50:20

The same event could involve genuine human responsibility while simultaneously being incorporated into God's sovereign purpose.

We do not have to solve every philosophical difficulty before we can trust what Scripture clearly teaches.

Prayer: Infinite Attention

Lewis's illustration of the author becomes especially meaningful when applied to prayer.

We tend to think of prayer in temporal terms:

I prayed yesterday.

I am praying today.

I will pray tomorrow.

But God is not limited by our perception of time.

That does not mean prayer is unnecessary or that our prayers are predetermined and therefore meaningless. Scripture repeatedly commands us to pray.

Rather, it means that our prayers are heard by a God whose knowledge and attention are not constrained as ours are.

Jesus said:

“Are not five sparrows sold for two pennies? And not one of them is forgotten before God.”
—Luke 12:6

If God does not overlook a sparrow, neither does He overlook one of His children.

This is perhaps the most practical consequence of the entire discussion:

God has time for you.

Indeed, if God transcends our temporal limitations, the believer never needs to fear that God is too busy to hear.

When the Believer Takes His Last Breath

What happens to the believer at the moment of death?

On this point, Scripture is remarkably clear. Paul writes:

“For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.”
—Philippians 1:21

He explains why:

“My desire is to depart and be with Christ, for that is far better.”
—Philippians 1:23

Even more explicitly, Paul writes:

“We are confident, yes, well pleased rather to be absent from the body and to be present with the Lord.” — 2 Corinthians 5:8

The statement is remarkably direct. Paul does not say that being absent from the body will eventually result in being with the Lord. He places the two realities together: *to be absent from the body is to be present with the Lord.*

Jesus gave the same assurance to the repentant thief:

“Today you will be with me in paradise.”
—Luke 23:43

The biblical picture is therefore clear: *when the believer takes his last breath, he is immediately in the presence of Christ.*

But this raises an intriguing question concerning the resurrection.

From our earthly perspective, a Christian may die today while Christ's return and the resurrection may occur years, centuries, or even millennia later. Yet the believer who dies is immediately with Christ. What, then, does that intervening period mean from the believer's perspective?

Here the biblical teaching leads naturally into the mystery of eternity.

If the believer is immediately present with Christ at death, it seems reasonable to conclude that he does not experience the intervening centuries as we experience the passage of earthly time. The calendar continues for those who remain on earth, but the believer's experience is no longer governed by earthly time in the same way.

This is where Arthur C. Custance's argument becomes especially compelling. Custance proposed that when a Christian dies, he passes from this realm of time and space into a spiritual realm in which time is not experienced as it is here. Consequently, what remains future to those living on earth may be experienced by the departed believer as immediately present.

This does not eliminate the future resurrection. Scripture clearly teaches that Christ will return and that “the dead in Christ will rise first” (1 Thessalonians 4:16). The resurrection remains future in the chronology of earthly history.

But from the perspective of the believer who has died, the passage of earthly centuries may not constitute a conscious period of waiting.

This is the remarkable implication of Paul's words. The mystery is not *whether* the believer is with Christ after death—Scripture settles that. The mystery is *how the believer experiences the interval between death and resurrection.*

Perhaps the answer lies precisely in the distinction between *time* and *eternity* that we have been exploring throughout this paper.

The Resurrection and the Return of Christ

Paul teaches that the resurrection of believers is directly connected with Christ's return:

“For the Lord himself will descend from heaven with a cry of command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the sound of the trumpet of God. And the dead in Christ will rise first. Then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air.” —1 Thessalonians 4:16–17

From our earthly perspective, this event remains future. The resurrection of the body will occur when Christ returns.

But this does not mean that believers who have died are presently separated from Christ or waiting apart from Him for the resurrection. Scripture has already established what happens when the believer leaves this body:

“To be absent from the body [is] to be present with the Lord.”
—2 Corinthians 5:8

The believer who dies is immediately with Christ.

This creates a remarkable distinction between *earthly chronology* and the believer's experience after death. From our perspective, centuries may pass between the death of a believer and the return of Christ. But the believer is already in the presence of the Lord throughout that entire period.

If, as we have proposed, the believer passes from our temporal existence into a realm where earthly time no longer governs experience in the same way, then the centuries that remain before Christ's return may not be experienced as centuries at all.

The resurrection, therefore, is still future in the chronology of human history, but it need not involve a prolonged conscious wait for the believer who has died.

This helps explain why Paul's words are so powerful. He does not tell the believer to look forward to death as a long period of waiting before being reunited with Christ. He says:

“My desire is to depart and be with Christ, for that is far better.”
—Philippians 1:23

Death brings the believer into the immediate presence of Christ. The resurrection subsequently brings the glorification of the believer's body when Christ returns.

Thus, two truths stand together:

At death, the believer is immediately present with Christ.

At Christ's return, the believer's body is resurrected and glorified.

From our earthly perspective, those events may appear separated by a vast span of time. From the believer's perspective, however, that interval may be nonexistent—or so brief that it is experienced as an immediate transition.

This is not uncertainty about whether the believer is with Christ. Scripture is clear about that. The remaining mystery concerns how eternity alters the believer's experience of what, from our earthly perspective, appears to be a lengthy interval.

And that brings us back to the central theme of this paper: *time and eternity are not necessarily experienced in the same way by God and His creatures.*

For the believer, death is therefore not a prolonged separation from Christ while awaiting His return. It is an immediate entrance into His presence, followed by the promised resurrection and glorification of the body when He comes.

As Paul simply and triumphantly declared:

“To live is Christ, and to die is gain.”
—Philippians 1:21

The Saints from Adam to the Last Believer

The implications become even more remarkable when we consider the resurrection of all the saints throughout history.

From our earthly perspective, Adam lived and died thousands of years before Christ. Abraham, Paul, and countless other believers likewise lived and died across the centuries. The final believer to die before Christ's return may die only moments before the resurrection.

Yet Scripture teaches:

“The dead in Christ will rise first.”
—1 Thessalonians 4:16

This raises a profound question: If Adam has been with Christ since the beginning of human history, Paul since the first century, and another believer may die immediately before Christ returns, how might they experience the resurrection?

Arthur C. Custance explored this question in *Time and Eternity*. He proposed that when a believer dies, he passes from our temporal existence into the presence of Christ, where earthly time is no longer experienced as it is here. If so, the centuries separating the deaths of different saints may not be experienced as centuries by those who have entered eternity.

This leads to an extraordinary possibility.

My mother and father have already died and are now in the presence of Christ. My brothers and sisters may die at different times. From our earthly perspective, these deaths occur on different dates, perhaps separated by many years.

Yet if the believer's experience of time changes upon entering eternity, those years may not constitute years of conscious waiting for the departed. My mother and father are with Christ now, while their glorified bodies await the resurrection.

When Christ returns, they—and all the saints who have died throughout history—will be raised. From our earthly perspective, Adam's death and my mother's death may be separated by thousands of years, while another believer may die moments before Christ returns. Yet from the

perspective of those who have entered Christ's presence, the resurrection may be experienced as though it follows immediately after death.

Thus, the saints do not enter Christ's presence at the same chronological moment. *They enter His presence individually at death.* What may be experienced together is the resurrection—the moment when Christ returns and the dead in Christ receive their glorified bodies.

The same could be true of the saints throughout history. Adam, Abraham, Paul, my mother and father, my brothers and sisters, and the last believer to die may all experience the resurrection together when Christ returns.

No one arrives early. No one arrives late.

This possibility also helps us appreciate the remarkable statement at the conclusion of Hebrews 11:

“And all these, though commended through their faith, did not receive what was promised, since God had provided something better for us, that apart from us they should not be made perfect.”
—Hebrews 11:39–40

The writer is speaking of believers who lived and died long before Christ, yet says they would not be “made perfect” apart from us. Their ultimate completion awaits the resurrection in which the saints of every generation will share.

From our perspective, some of these believers have been dead for thousands of years. Yet the way they experience the passage of time in the presence of Christ may be profoundly different from our earthly experience. Revelation gives us a glimpse of this heavenly existence in the souls of the martyrs who cry out, “How long?” as they await God's final judgment and vindication (Revelation 6:9–11). They are already in God's presence, yet they remain conscious of a future event.

This reminds us that we should not assume that eternity means the complete absence of sequence or awareness. The departed saints are conscious, they worship, they remember, they anticipate, and they await the fulfillment of God's purposes. Yet their experience of that waiting may be entirely different from our experience of earthly time.

This is not something Scripture explicitly explains in philosophical terms. Scripture clearly teaches two things: the believer is immediately present with Christ after death, and the dead in Christ will be raised when He returns. Cushman's proposal offers a compelling way of understanding how those two truths might be experienced by believers who die at vastly different points in earthly history.

The biblical hope, however, is certain:

“The dead in Christ will rise first.”
—1 Thessalonians 4:16

And when they do, every believer who has ever trusted in Christ will share together in the glory of the resurrection.

Eternity and the Book of Revelation

This understanding of time and eternity becomes especially important when we approach the book of Revelation.

Revelation presents a remarkable mixture of heavenly reality and earthly sequence.

John is taken into a heavenly vision and shown things that transcend ordinary human experience. Yet he describes what he sees using human language and temporal categories.

This should not surprise us.

John was a human being receiving revelation from God.

He was not suddenly given a vocabulary capable of describing every dimension of heavenly reality. He had to communicate what he saw in terms his readers could understand.

At the same time, Revelation repeatedly presents events unfolding in sequence.

The seals are opened.

The trumpets sound.

The bowls of judgment are poured out.

The beast rises.

Christ returns.

Satan is judged.

The final judgment occurs.

The New Heaven and New Earth appear.

Thus, Revelation does not require us to conclude that everything described in heaven is occurring outside all sequence.

Instead, we should distinguish between *the eternal God who reveals the vision* and *the created beings who experience the revealed events*.

That distinction becomes particularly important in Revelation 8:1.

The Difficulty of Revelation 8:1

Revelation 8:1 presents a fascinating difficulty:

“When the Lamb opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven for about half an hour.”

If God is eternal and transcends time, how can there be “half an hour” in heaven?

Perhaps the answer is that we are attempting to understand a reality that Scripture only partially reveals. God has revealed enough for faith, but not enough for exhaustive explanation.

The “half hour” need not contradict God's timelessness. It may instead remind us to distinguish between *God's eternal existence* and *the experience of created beings within His creation*. The half hour of silence emphasizes that something extraordinary is happening. The four living creatures around the throne are continually praising God, yet suddenly there is silence. The abrupt cessation of their continual worship underscores the solemn significance of what is about to unfold.

John's vision therefore gives us a glimpse into heavenly reality without explaining its metaphysical structure.

The silence of heaven is real. The significance of the moment is real. The judgment that follows is real.

But exactly how a “half hour” relates to eternity remains a mystery—and perhaps that is precisely where it belongs.

As Paul reminds us:

“For now we see in a mirror dimly, but then face to face.”
—1 Corinthians 13:12

From Time to Eternity

There is something humbling about contemplating eternity.

We measure our lives in years.

God is not bound by time.

We remember yesterday.

God knows all history.

We anticipate tomorrow.

God knows the end from the beginning.

We experience life one moment at a time.

God's relationship to creation transcends our limited perspective.

Yet the greatest Christian hope is not merely that we will someday escape time. For the believer who dies, the immediate reality is being with Christ. Our ultimate hope, however, extends beyond the intermediate state to the resurrection and glorification of the body, when Christ returns.

Our hope is that we will be with Christ.

Jesus said:

“I will come again and will take you to myself, that where I am you may be also.”
—John 14:3

That promise is greater than our ability to explain eternity.

The Christian does not need to understand every mystery surrounding time and eternity in order to trust the God who created both.

We know that God is eternal.

We know that Christ existed before creation.

We know that Christ entered human history.

We know that He died for our sins.

We know that He rose from the dead.

We know that He will return.

And we know that those who belong to Him are with Him when they die and will ultimately be with Him forever in resurrected and glorified bodies.

John's final vision brings the entire biblical story to its conclusion:

“Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away.”
—Revelation 21:1

And then:

“Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man. He will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God.”
—Revelation 21:3

The Bible does not end with humanity discovering the secrets of eternity.

It ends with God dwelling with His people.

And Revelation concludes with the promise:

“Surely I am coming soon.”

To which the Church responds:

“Amen. Come, Lord Jesus!”

Whatever eternity ultimately means for us, this much is certain:

The believer's future is not an endless existence separated from God.

It is the forever-presence of the One who loved us, redeemed us, and promised to bring us home.

One day, in the twinkling of an eye, those believers who are still living on earth will be caught up to meet Him, while those who have already died in Christ will be raised and receive their new glorified bodies. And from that moment forward, every question about time, eternity, death, resurrection, and the future will finally be eclipsed by the reality of His presence.

As Paul wrote:

“Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I have been fully known.”
—1 Corinthians 13:12

Amen.

Sources

Scripture

English Standard Version (ESV).

Augustine

Relevant writings concerning eternity and the nature of time.

C. S. Lewis

Relevant discussions of time, eternity, prayer, and the author's relationship to the story.

Arthur C. Custance

Time and Eternity.

Albert Einstein / Philipp Frank

Discussions concerning the relationship between matter, space, and time.

Lambert Dolphin

Relevant discussions concerning time and eternity.

Original Material

The poem *Time* is original to the author.